

Lab Books and Implementation

Lab Books

You are expected to keep a complete and contemporaneous record of the work done during your project (the "lab book"), irrespective of the type of project. This is similar to what is done for third-year lab. This record will be assessed by your supervisor before the deadline for the report.

The record should include, e.g.: planning, notes made from existing literature with details of the references, calculations, notes about analysis, discussion, problems encountered, solutions tried, and results. It should be possible for someone else to reconstruct your entire project from this record alone.

You can show your lab book to your project partner, but each student should keep an individual record for which they take full responsibility. It cannot be copy-pasted from each other. The work undertaken by your project partner does not necessarily need to be described in full in your lab book, but some details might need to be summarised to reflect your understanding of how your complementary work fits into the project as a whole.

You can choose to keep this record in a physical notebook or in electronic form. If you keep an electronic record, please back this up regularly and ensure that you use a software package that allows all your notes to be exported as a single PDF for assessment. (Microsoft OneNote, e.g., does not always allow you to export multiple pages as a single PDF file.)

Implementation

After reviewing your record keeping, your supervisor will award you marks for your lab book, for "effort, initiative, critical thinking and originality", and for the "extent and quality of work". These marks and your supervisor's feedback will be released to you after your Presentation and Interview. Please note that all marks are provisional until after the meeting of the exam board.

Please be reminded that the "Extent and quality of work" criterion of the Implementation mark takes into consideration what could have realistically been expected given the circumstances involved in the project. Students will not be penalised for lack of progress that results from things outside their control, such as faulty equipment, students working alone rather than together with a partner, or having to work remotely.